Specification of the controlled designation of origin “GIGONDAS”

Approved by the order of 10 December 2024, JORF of 12 December 2024

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin “Gigondas”, initially recognised by the decree of 6 January 1971.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin “Gigondas” is reserved for still white, red and rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification and the elaboration of the wines are carried out within the territory of the commune of Gigondas in the Vaucluse department, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2023.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 13 March 2008 and 30 June 2023.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of Gigondas the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification and the elaboration of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes of the Vaucluse department, on the basis of the official geographic code of the year 2023: Aubignan, Le Barroux, Beaumes-de- Venise, Beaumont-du-Ventoux, Bédarrides, Bollène, Buisson, Caderousse, Cairanne, Camaret-sur-Aigues, Caromb, Carpentras, Châteauneuf-du-Pape, Courthézon, Le Crestet, Entrechaux, Faucon, Jonquières, Lafare, Lagarde-Paréol, Lamotte-du-Rhône, Lapalud, Loriol- du-Comtat, Malaucène, Mazan, Mondragon, Mornas, Orange, Piolenc, Puyméras, Rasteau, Roaix, La Roque-Alric, Sablet, Sainte-Cécile-les-Vignes, Saint-Hippolyte-le-Graveyron, Saint- Léger-du-Ventoux, Saint-Marcellin-lès-Vaison, Saint-Romain-en-Viennois, Saint-Roman-de- Malegarde, Sarrians, Séguret, Sérignan-du-Comtat, Sorgues, Suzette, Travaillan, Uchaux, Vacqueyras, Vaison-la-Romaine, Vedène, Villedieu, Violès, Visan.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The white wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: clairette B; - complementary varieties: bourboulenc B, clairette rose Rs, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, marsanne B, piquepoul blanc B, roussanne B; - accessory varieties: viognier B, ugni blanc B; - varieties “of interest for adaptation purposes”: piquepoul gris G, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG (defence and management body), the grape-producing operator and the vinifying operator of an agreement in conformity with the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee.

b) – The red and rosé wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: grenache N; - complementary varieties: syrah N, mourvèdre N, cinsaut N; - accessory varieties: bourboulenc B, brun argenté N (locally called camarèse or vaccarèse), carignan N, clairette B, clairette rose Rs, counoise N, grenache blanc B, grenache gris G, marsanne B, muscardin N, piquepoul blanc B, piquepoul noir N,

roussanne B, terret noir N, ugni blanc B, viognier B; - varieties “of interest for adaptation purposes”: piquepoul gris G, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG, the grape-producing operator and the vinifying operator of an agreement in conformity with the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee.

c) – Plantings may not be carried out with the following plant material: - for the grenache N variety: clones 134, 137, 224, 287, 432, 514, 517, 814; - for the syrah N variety: clones 73, 99, 301, 381, 382, 383.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

a) – The conformity of the grape varieties is assessed for the colour concerned, over the totality of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin. The proportion of varieties “of interest for adaptation purposes” is limited to 5 % of the total area of the holding, all colours combined, claimed under the AOC Gigondas.

b) – For the whites: - The proportion of the main variety is greater than or equal to 70 % of the grape varieties; - The proportion of the accessory varieties may not exceed 5 % of the grape varieties.

c) – For the reds and rosés, the proportion of the whole of the main variety and complementary varieties is greater than or equal to 90 % of the grape varieties; - The proportion of the grenache N variety is greater than or equal to 50 % of the grape varieties; - The proportion of the whole of the cinsaut N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties is greater than or equal to 15 % of the grape varieties.

d) – In the event of an involuntary change of structure of the holding (succession, termination of lease, liquidation of companies, expropriations), the operator has a period of five years from the date of the change of structure so that the grape varieties of the holding meet the proportion rules defined in the present specification.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.

- The spacing between rows may not be greater than 2.50 metres. - Each plant has a maximum area of 2.50 square metres. This area is obtained by multiplying the inter-row and inter-plant distances within the same row. - The spacing between plants within the same row is between 0.80 metre and 1.25 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.

GENERAL PROVISIONS
- The vines are short-pruned (goblet or Royat cordon), with a maximum of 6 spurs per plant. Each spur bears a maximum of 2 free eyes (buds); - The establishment or rejuvenation period of the Royat cordon is limited to 2 years. During this period, single Guyot pruning with a maximum of 8 free eyes on the long cane and a spur with a maximum of 2 free eyes, or double Guyot pruning with 2 canes with 5 eyes and 2 recall spurs of 2 eyes each, are authorised.
PARTICULAR PROVISION
The syrah N and viognier B varieties may be pruned in single Guyot with a maximum of 8 free eyes on the long cane and 1 or 2 spurs with a maximum of 2 free eyes.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.

- For vines trained in Royat cordon, the maximum height of the cordon must be between 0.30 and 0.65 metre at planting, this height being measured from the ground to the lower part of the framework arms; - For vines trained according to the “raised single-plane trellising” method, the height of the trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.5 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire. - For all the other training methods, the length of the shoots, after topping, may not be less than 0.70 metre. - The syrah N variety is compulsorily trellised, either on stakes or in “raised single-plane trellising” with, in the latter case, at least one carrier wire and one level of lifting wires.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
- For the white grapes intended for the production of white wine, the average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 7,000 kilograms per hectare; - For the production of the red and rosé wines, the average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 6,500 kilograms per hectare; - Where irrigation is authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, the average maximum load per parcel of the irrigated parcels is fixed at 4,500 kilograms per hectare for the red and rosé wines and 5,300 kilograms per hectare for the white wines.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The maximum percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment that constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir: - Plastic mulching is prohibited; - Any substantial modification of the morphology of the relief and of the natural pedological sequence of the parcels intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin (levelling, filling, cutting, etc.) is prohibited, with the exception of reprofiling and classic deep-ploughing works.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation may be authorised in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-5 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

b) – Particular harvesting provisions. - The grapes are picked and transported to the place of vinification in a good sanitary condition. - The sorting of the harvest is compulsory whatever the harvesting method. The sorting is carried out either on the parcel or at the place of vinification.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) – Sugar richness of the grapes. Grapes presenting a sugar content lower than the following may not be considered as being at proper ripeness: - 196 grams per litre of must for the white varieties; - 202 grams per litre of must for the cinsaut N, mourvèdre N and syrah N varieties; - 210 grams per litre of must for the other varieties.

b) – Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume. The red and rosé wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 12.5 %. The white wines present a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 12 %.

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 36 hectolitres per hectare for the red and rosé wines. For the white wines, the yield is fixed at 40 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 40 hectolitres per hectare for the red and rosé wines. For the white wines, the limit yield is fixed at 44 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Loss of the benefit of the controlled designation of origin

The wines are obtained within the limit of a yield of 42 hectolitres per hectare for the reds and rosés and 48 hectolitres per hectare for the white wines. This yield corresponds to the total production of the claimed parcels. Any exceeding of this yield causes the whole of the harvest to lose the benefit of the controlled designation of origin.

4° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 3rd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties. The red and rosé wines come from grapes or wines arising at least 50 % from the main variety. The white wines come from grapes or wines arising at least 70 % from the main variety. The proportion of the whole of the varieties “of interest for adaptation purposes” may not be greater than 10 % in the blend.

b) – Malolactic fermentation. For the red wines, the malic acid content is less than or equal to 0.3 gram per litre at the packaging stage.

c) – Analytical standards. At the packaging stage: - The rosé wines present a volatile acidity content less than or equal to 14.28 milliequivalents per litre; - The white and red wines present a volatile acidity content less than or equal to 17.30 milliequivalents per litre; - The content of fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose) is less than or equal to 3 grams per litre; - For the red wines, the total polyphenol index is greater than or equal to 45.

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments. - Any thermal treatment of the harvest involving a temperature greater than 40 °C is prohibited; - The use of pieces of wood is prohibited; - For the elaboration of the rosé wines, the use of charcoals for oenological use, alone or in a mixture in preparations, is prohibited; - The wines do not exceed, after enrichment, a total alcoholic strength by volume of 14.5 %.

e) – Prohibited equipment. - The use of finned pumps for handling the harvest is prohibited; - The use of continuous presses is prohibited.

f) – Vat capacity. Every operator has an overall vat capacity greater than or equal to 1.5 times the product of the yield referred to at 1° of point VIII by the area in production vinified at the cellar.

g) – Overall upkeep of the cellar and equipment. The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Wine analysis obligations

For all the homogeneous lots of wines, the operator keeps available for the approved control body an analysis covering the following parameters:

Before 31 December of the year of harvest and, as the case may be, of the production declaration for the cooperative cellars (SV11) or of the production declaration of the vinifying merchants (SV12)

White, red or rosé wines	- Total acidity; - Volatile acidity; - Actual alcoholic strength by volume; - Fermentable sugars (glucose + fructose); - Total sulphur dioxide; - pH
Red wines	Total polyphenol index
During the conservation of the non-packaged wines and at least every 4 months from the date of the previous analysis	
White, red or rosé wines	- Volatile acidity; - Free sulphur dioxide

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports are kept for a period of at least 6 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – The white and rosé wines are placed on the market for the consumer according to the provisions of Article D. 645-17 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

b) – The red wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 31 January of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

Within the southern vineyards of the Rhône Valley and recognised as a “Cru des Côtes du Rhône”, the territory of the controlled designation of origin “Gigondas” is inseparable from the remarkable limestone massif of the Dentelles de Montmirail. This admirable mountain, “mons mirabilis”, bears witness to the first Alpine advance towards the Rhône Valley, which it comes partially to cut from east to west. An imposing relief, culminating at 630 metres of altitude at the Rocher du Turc, a spectacular relief through the play of erosion, it constitutes the most complex geological structure on the left bank of the Rhône, with substrates arising from the Triassic, Jurassic and Cretaceous formations, surrounded by a halo of Oligocene and Miocene formations.

The geographical area is reserved for the sole commune of Gigondas situated in the Vaucluse department. This territory is delimited by the line of the Dentelles de Montmirail oriented from east to west. It is formed by a series of hillsides and undulations that follow one another, inclining towards the north-west as far as the valley of the Ouvèze which it overhangs by a cliff. Its natural limits are as follows: - To the north, a torrent, the Trignon, flowing over a stony bed that it gullies without bringing any alluvial element; - To the south, the hills prolonging the Dentelles between Gigondas and Vacqueyras; - To the east, the line of hills of the Dentelles de Montmirail joining, towards the north, the mountainous massif of the Crêtes de Saint-Amand which culminates at 730 metres of altitude, and the heights of Séguret and Crestet; - To the west, the Ouvèze, flowing at the edge of a few thin alluvial formations.

The vineyard extends, in its greatest part, over two strongly represented bases: - The high part which rests on sandy and limestone molasses, with skeletal and light soils, very hot and resistant to drought; - The low part, made up of ancient alluvium with shattered pebbles, on the terraces of the Ouvèze. These are most often red soils (diluvium, loess, sandstone), and mostly soils of high permeability, of strong stoniness and rich in clay fraction.

The vineyard is established at an altitude of between 160 metres and 400 metres, on west/north-west exposures that protect from the excessive summer sunshine. Its situation on hillsides protects it from the

fogs and the spring frosts and ensures each year a regular harvest.

The climate is a Provençal climate par excellence, a climate of contrast subject to the heat of the Mediterranean summer and to the violence of the Mistral. As in the whole Mediterranean region, the rains can be torrential at the equinox periods.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

In the first century AD, PLINY THE ELDER in book XIV of his "Natural History" already celebrates the virtues of the wines harvested on the hillsides bordering the valley of the Ouvèze. For two millennia, the village of Gigondas, at the foot of the Dentelles de Montmirail, lives principally from the vine. The creation of the first wine estates is attributed to the soldiers of the 2nd Roman legion.

The monastery of Notre-Dame de Prébayon (611) and the priory of Saint-André are, in their times, places of residence regularly frequented by the bishops of Vaison and Orange. Fine connoisseurs, the prelates apply themselves to producing much-appreciated wines. The first measure in favour of quality at "Gigondas" dates from 1771. According to an extract of the deliberation of the Political Council of the Community of Gigondas, dated 30 September 1771, it is stated "that no one may harvest before the general permission to be given by the Consuls, on pain of 5 pounds of fine for each contravention".

In the 19th century, the vine would have kept a modest place (some fifty hectares) had Eugène RASPAIL not understood the excellence of the conditions for supplying a great wine. Despite the dramatic phylloxera episode which leads to the partial abandonment of the vine in favour of the olive grove, the history of the vine in the following century fulfils his predictions.

The frost of the winter of 1956, following that of 1929, upsets the agricultural physiognomy of "Gigondas". Many olive groves disappear, carried off by a cold that the olive trees cannot resist. This climatic accident again tips the balance in favour of the vine. The cooperative cellar is created in this context. From then on, the production and the notoriety of the wines of "Gigondas" never cease to grow. Strong with this reputation, relying on the law of 6 May 1919, the wines are claimed under the designation of origin "Gigondas" as early as 1924. Initially inscribed within the geographical area of the controlled designation of origin "Côtes du Rhône" (decree of 19 November 1937), the production of "Gigondas" is quickly recognised for its quality and for the identity of its wines. The name of the commune can then naturally be associated, as early as 1951, with the name of the controlled designation of origin "Côtes du Rhône" and, by decree of 6 January 1971, the controlled designation of origin "Gigondas" is recognised, thus joining the family of the "Crus des Côtes du Rhône".

In 2009, the vineyard covers an area of 1,230 hectares for an average production of 32,500 hectolitres. The wines are divided into 3 colours: red wines, which represent 99 % of the production, and, more confidentially, rosé and white wines. 80 % of the wines are produced by private cellars.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The red and rosé wines come mainly from the grenache N, syrah N and mourvèdre N varieties. The grenache N variety brings tannins and roundness to the blends. This geographical area allows it to express itself in all its fullness. Indeed, by limiting the morning sunshine, the Dentelles considerably lengthen its ripeness, which must be progressive in order to express itself at its best. Associated in moderate quantities, while respecting the character of the wine, the syrah N variety reinforces the colour, the aromatic intensity and the ageing aptitude. The mourvèdre N variety, through its high antioxidant power, is the perfect complement to the grenache N variety. It heightens the aromatic complexity, brings spicy notes and is perfectly suited to ageing in wood. The red wine is a wine for keeping which presents a shimmering colour ranging from ruby to dark garnet. Full-bodied, generous, it reveals a bouquet of red fruits and very ripe black fruits in its youth. It will evolve towards wild nuances of undergrowth and truffles.

The rosé wine represents a very small proportion of the production but it deserves the greatest interest, notably through its amplitude on the palate. Its robe is of a deep colour, pink with violet glints. Its nose is distinguished by its bouquet of almond and small cooked fruits. Its palate is at once heady and balanced.

The white wines are produced on three sectors that express themselves through their minerality and their balance and present a bright robe, of pale colour with green glints which, with ageing, may take on

somewhat deeper and golden notes. In the high situations, the white varieties, mainly the Clairette, benefit from a slow ripeness to reveal the freshness. The minerality, for its part, is revealed by the limestone substrate. The combination of these 2 elements generates an aerial dimension in the wines. On the colluvium cone, the white varieties acquire a somewhat denser matter while expressing once again the presence of the limestone that is found everywhere at Gigondas. In the Miocene sands, the white varieties, in particular the Clairette, express there the salinity and the aromatic complexity.

3° – Causal interactions

"Gigondas", formerly named "jucunditas" which means "joy and merriment" in Latin, may, quite rightly, be considered as a commune of predilection for a production of wines of strong identity and of long-recognised quality. The human community of this commune has historically known how to bring out the natural qualities of this territory, a veritable land of election for the vine, and to respect the originality of the raw material that results from its work of the land.

At the heart of a landscape as sumptuous as it is beneficial through the mesoclimate it generates, within a zone of holm oak and olive trees, the vineyard is established on permeable soils attenuating the erosion linked to runoff waters and allowing a rapid draining of the carefully selected parcels. The soils generally associate a clayey matrix conducive to a controlled water regime and a strong stoniness which will on the one hand contribute to draining and on the other hand have a very positive thermal impact during the ripeness phase of the grapes. The altitude of the hillsides (160 metres to 400 metres), situated above the fogs of the Rhône, and their inclination (north-north-west) avoid both excessive sunshine and spring frosts.

The climate of the commune of Gigondas thus makes it possible to benefit from all the advantages of the Provençal climate — sunshine and Mistral, a cold and dry wind that limits the development of cryptogamic diseases and favours the natural concentrations of the berries — without suffering the disadvantages thereof, thanks to the protection offered by the chain of the Dentelles de Montmirail. This set of factors, associated with the winegrowers' work and know-how — which express themselves notably through the choice of the grape varieties and through the respect of the harvest by imposing a compulsory sorting — have made possible, for two millennia, the recognition, the development of the notoriety and above all the maintenance of the identity of the wines produced within the controlled designation of origin "Gigondas".

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Grape varieties and proportion rules on the holding

The provisions relating to the prohibition of certain clones apply only to the plantings carried out from the 2011-2012 wine-growing campaign.

2° – Training methods

a) – Planting density. The provisions relating to planting density apply to the plantings carried out after 31 July 2009. The parcels planted with vine before 31 July 2009 and not meeting the provisions relating to planting density continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, subject to compliance with the provisions relating to the foliage height fixed in the present specification.

b) – Trellising rules and foliage height. - The provision relating to the trellising obligation for the syrah N variety does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009. - The provision relating to the height of the cordon does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009.

c) – Pruning rules. The vines planted before 31 July 1980 are pruned with a maximum of 14 free eyes per plant.

3° – Other cultivation practices

The provision relating to the prohibition of plastic mulching does not apply to the plantings carried out before 31 July 2009.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Gigondas” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered and accompanied by the term “Appellation d'origine contrôlée”, all in very conspicuous characters.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that: - it is a registered cadastral lieu-dit; - it appears on the harvest declaration.

b) – The labelling of the wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit “Cru des Côtes du Rhône” or “Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône”. The conditions of use of the larger geographical unit “Vignobles de la Vallée du Rhône” are specified by the agreement signed between the various defence and management bodies concerned. This term must appear in the same visual field as all the compulsory indications, and be printed in characters of the same graphics and the same colour as the appellation, without the dimensions of this term exceeding two-thirds of those of the appellation.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before the first bulk transaction or the first packaging, and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest. It indicates: - the designation claimed; - the volume of the wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, before 1 May preceding the harvest, the parcels for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

3. Declaration of bulk transaction or of bulk sale to the consumer and declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

A declaration of bulk transaction, or a declaration of bulk sale to the consumer, is sent to the approved control body at the latest ten working days before the date of exit from the cellars. This declaration specifies, where applicable, whether the non-packaged wine is intended to be dispatched outside the national territory.

4. Packaging declaration

A packaging declaration must be sent to the approved control body at the latest 3 working days after the end of the packaging.

5. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of one month after this downgrading.

6. Reworking of parcels

Before any addition of soil, any development or any works liable to modify the soil profile or the morphology of the relief (in particular if these works exceed 2 metres in cut or in fill) and with the

exception of classic deep-ploughing works, a declaration is sent by the operator to the defence and management body at least two months before the date scheduled for these works. The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

7. Declaration of intention of mechanical harvest (control of the sorting of the harvest)

A declaration of intention of mechanical harvest is sent to the defence and management body before 31 July preceding the harvest. However, by exceptional derogation and upon reasoned request, this declaration may be sent at the latest eight days before the harvest.

II. – Keeping of registers

No specific provision.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary check (up-to-date CVI record)
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of transitional measures)	Documentary check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Average maximum load per parcel	Counting of the average number of bunches and estimation of the load by multiplying this number by the average weight of a bunch (adapted to the variety)
Upkeep of the parcel and other cultivation practices	Check of the overall upkeep of the parcel (weed management, sanitary condition, trellising)
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes	Check of the carrying out of the ripeness monitoring on a witness parcel defined for the main varieties of the holding
Sorting of the harvest	Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Monitoring of the product	Check of the carrying out of a complete analysis of the wine before the harvest declaration, the production declaration for the cooperative cellars (SV 11) or the production declaration of the vinifying merchants (SV 12)
Conservation	Check of the analytical monitoring of the wine (check of free SO2 and volatile acidity)
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	Documentary check (register keeping) and check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check (check of declarations, increase of the yield for certain operators [monitoring of the authorisations granted by the INAO services, after enquiry by the said services upon individual request of the operator])
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check (monitoring of destruction certificates)
Claim declaration	Documentary check and on-site check (compliance with the arrangements and deadlines, consistency with the harvest declaration or production declaration). Control of the placing into circulation of the products
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	

At the stage of the placing into circulation of the non-packaged products and at the packaging stage	Complete analytical examination of the wine
At the stage of the placing into circulation of the non-packaged products and/or at the packaging stage	Organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots

II. – References concerning the control structure

National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO)
TSA 30003
93555 – MONTREUIL Cedex
Tel: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00
Email: info@inao.gouv.fr

The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out on the basis of an approved control plan and by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, having received delegation from the INAO.